

masses can understand.” One of his best-known compositions, the oratorio *The Raft of the Medusa*, was written in honor of the recently killed revolutionary Che Guevara and provoked a riot at its premiere in Hamburg in 1968. In addition to operas, ballets, and other stage works, his output included much orchestral music (notably 10 symphonies) and chamber music. Stylistically his work is varied, influenced by jazz and Arabic music, among other sources.

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**KEY WORKS:** *Boulevard Solitude*, 1951; *The Raft of the Medusa*, 1968; *We Come to the River*, 1976; *Symphony No. 10*, 2000

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## Sofia Gubaidulina

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born 1931, RUSSIAN

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The outstanding female composer to emerge from the Soviet Union, Gubaidulina has lived in Germany since 1992 and by the turn of the century had an international reputation, winning numerous awards and attracting commissions from leading orchestras and soloists. She is deeply spiritual and her works are often informed by religious and philosophical ideas and by a sense of mystical yearning (in 1979, she was denounced by